

PROCEDURE

Workable items — the procedure

Document	docs/workable-items/ PROCEDURE.md
Revision	1
Created	2026-09-08
Anchors	§11.4.93, §11.4.95, §11.4.54, §11.4.15, §11.4.16, §11.4.33, §11.4.90, §11.4.148, §11.4.63, §11.4.208
Status of this document	The single source of truth for HOW work is tracked here (§11.4.63). Where it disagrees with submodules/constitution/ Constitution.md, the constitution wins.

What exists, and where

Artefact	Path	Authored by
The database — the single source of truth	docs/ workable_items.db	the canonical binary (schema) + the umbrella tool (rows)
The identifier roster	docs/workable-items/ sub-projects.tsv	the operator (five names) + this agent (ten proposals)
The canonical tracker binary	submodules/ constitution/ scripts/workable-	upstream, consumed

Artefact	Path	Authored by
	items/bin/workable-items-linux	
The umbrella-local tool	_tools/workable-items/	this repository
The gate	scripts/verify-workable-items.sh	this repository

Why there are two binaries and not one

§11.4.93 places the tracker upstream and says so in terms:

“The Go binary lives in the constitution submodule (constitution/scripts/workable-items/) so consumers reference it from there per §11.4.74 catalogue-first discipline — **never reimplement.**”

That binary is present, builds nothing here, and runs on this host. It owns the schema and every lifecycle mutation: add, update, reopen, move, block, close, obsolete-details, report, diary, export, sync db-to-md, sync md-to-db, diff, validate. **Use it for all of those.** Writing a second one would be the reimplement the anchor forbids.

The umbrella tool exists for the two things the canonical binary does not do, and could not: this monorepo has FIFTEEN identifier-bearing sub-projects while the canonical tool derives exactly ONE three-letter key from the project root directory name (cmd/workable-items/prefix.go), and this repository’s backfill sources are its own.

The split is also deliberate on evidence grounds (§11.4.240, producer ≠ verifier): the rows are written by the tool this repository authors and checked by the binary it does not. That is not decorative. During the adoption work the upstream validator caught two real defects the umbrella validator was not looking for — items with no doc_segments row, which db-to-md would have silently dropped, and closure evidence_path values that were well-formed but resolved to nothing on disk.

The identifier scheme

<THREE UPPERCASE LETTERS>-<zero-padded number>, e.g. WSP-142.

§11.4.54 names ATM-NNN. §11.4.148 then makes the prefix consumer-supplied, in terms: “*the consuming project supplies its concrete DB path, **id prefix**, external-tracker service + list/board id + field map + default-assignee env var, and docs_chain context per §11.4.35.*” The three-letter shape is also what the canonical tracker’s own heading grammar requires (`^## [A-Z]{3}-...`). So the operator’s VSC / WSP / AII / MVR / VDT scheme is an instance of the mandate, not a deviation from it — no override is needed and none is claimed.

The FLEET is derived; the NAMES are not. The set of sub-projects comes from `.gitmodules` cross-checked against `helix-deps.yaml` at run time. The roster file supplies only the name for each derived member, because a name is an operator decision and cannot be measured. A submodule with no roster row makes the gate report **rc 2 — could not determine**, never a pass, so a new submodule cannot be silently dropped out of tracking.

Five names were stated by the operator. **Ten are PROPOSALS awaiting ratification** and are marked proposed in the roster file; `workable-items-vsc roster` prints the split on every run so a proposal is never mistaken for a decision.

Day-to-day

```
# What is open, and where
submodules/constitution/scripts/workable-items/bin/workable-items-
linux \
    report --db docs/workable_items.db --by-status

# Open a new item (the canonical binary owns every mutation)
submodules/constitution/scripts/workable-items/bin/workable-items-
linux \
    add Task medium --db docs/workable_items.db --prefix WSP \
    --title "<what>" --description "<WHAT / manifests / repro /
    acceptance>"

# Close one – evidence is mandatory and the path must RESOLVE
submodules/constitution/scripts/workable-items/bin/workable-items-
linux \
    close WSP-142 --db docs/workable_items.db --status completed \
    --evidence docs/qa/<artefact>

# The umbrella's own legs
_tools/workable-items/bin/workable-items-vsc roster
    # fleet vs identifiers
_tools/workable-items/bin/workable-items-vsc validate #
    integrity contract
```

```
_tools/workable-items/bin/workable-items-vsc report      # tallies
    incl. evidence class
```

```
# The gate, and its §1.1 paired proof
```

```
bash scripts/verify-workable-items.sh
```

```
bash scripts/verify-workable-items.sh --prove-failure
```

Build the umbrella tool with `cd _tools/workable-items && CGO_ENABLED=0 GOPROXY=off go build -o bin/workable-items-vsc .` It is pure Go on modernc.org/sqlite, following the monetization/tools/repodb precedent — no CGO, no network, no sqlite3 CLI dependency.

The vocabularies, and the one place they live

Status, type and the closure mapping are the constitution’s, not this repository’s. They are enforced twice: by CHECK constraints in the canonical schema, and by the umbrella validator.

Type (§11.4.16)	Closes as (§11.4.33)
Bug	Fixed (→ Fixed.md)
Feature	Implemented (→ Fixed.md)
Task	Completed (→ Fixed.md)

Obsolete (→ Fixed.md) is §11.4.90’s fourth terminal value and applies regardless of type. It requires an `obsolete_details` row carrying the triple-check evidence; the anchor’s words are “*There MUST NOT be any mistake*”.

The database is TRACKED. Never ignore it.

§11.4.95, verbatim:

“**TRACKED in git** at canonical path `docs/workable_items.db`. NEVER gitignored regardless of file-size or ‘build-artefact-class’ heuristics — the DB is NOT a build artefact, it IS authoritative source data.”

The `.db-wal` and `.db-shm` sidecars ARE ignored — the same anchor names them. The gate checks both directions and its paired proof drives the ignore predicate red against a throwaway repository, so “the DB is tracked” is a measured claim rather than a habit.

Honest boundaries (§11.4.6)

1. **The evidence class of a backfilled closure is recorded, and it is not a re-run.** Every item carries an `item_provenance` row naming the artefact its status rests on and the CLASS of that evidence: `document-assertion` (an operator-decision document states the outcome), `checkbox-state` (a tracked task list marks the row [x]), or `undetermined`. **No backfilled closure was re-verified by executing anything.** A Completed row backfilled from a [x] means the task list says so — nothing stronger. Query it: `SELECT evidence_class, count(*) FROM item_provenance GROUP BY 1;`
2. **The content-boundary gate cannot see inside this database.** `scripts/verify-content-boundary.sh` selects its corpus with `grep -I`, which excludes binary files, and a SQLite database is binary. The boundary argument for the DB therefore rests on provenance, not on that gate: every backfilled title is a verbatim substring of the already-public umbrella file it cites (checked mechanically over all 529 rows, 0 exceptions), and no row was sourced from a private submodule's own files.
3. **Type is Task on every backfilled row, by the anchor's own fallback.** §11.4.16: *"When ambiguous, fall back to Task."* Classifying 529 rows into Bug/Feature/Task from their prose would have been a guess wearing a classification's clothes. Re-typing an item is a one-command update.
4. **Severity is unset on every backfilled row.** No source states one, and §11.4.93 marks the column informational.
5. **Sub-project attribution is by measured path mention, not by subject.** A row naming no sub-project path, or naming paths in more than one, is attributed to the parent VSC — which is truthful, because the source document lives in the umbrella. One known conservative miss: an org-qualified name like `vasic-digital/design-toolkit` does not match the tree path `design-toolkit`, and lands on VSC.
6. **[BLOCKED: ...] task rows are recorded Queued, not Operator-blocked.** §11.4.21 and §11.4.148(D3) require a WHY, an exhausted-alternatives statement and an ENUMERATED set of unblock choices. The source rows supply none of the three, and inventing them to reach the stronger status would be the fabrication §11.4.6 forbids. Each such row says so in its own description.
7. **sync db-to-md has not been run and no Markdown surface is generated yet.** §11.4.93's bidirectional round-trip guarantee is therefore NOT demonstrated here. It is a tracked follow-up, not a shipped property.